



◀ ROUND SHOT

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Iron

Naval ammunition generally had three purposes – to punch holes in the side of an enemy ship, to bring down masts and sails, or to kill the enemy. An accurate and long-range type of munition, round shot was used for its penetrating effect against a ship's hull.



◀ CHAIN SHOT

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Iron

The chain shot – two or more cannonballs linked by a chain – could scythe down enemy crew on an exposed deck. Like other non-round shot, the range and accuracy of chain shot was poor.



◀ GRAPESHOT

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Canvas, iron

Grapeshot consisted of balls of metal housed within a tin or a canvas bag. The container shattered when a gun was fired, producing a shotgun-like effect against an enemy crew.



Extendable sections

Solid iron

◀ BAR SHOT

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Iron

The bar shot was made by linking two or more shot pieces by a fixed bar or extendable bar sections. It was designed to hack away at lines and rigging as it flew over the top of the ship's deck.

▼ RAMMER

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Ash

The rammer was used to push the cartridge, wads, and shot down the full length of the bore and pack it into the firing chamber of the gun.

Concave ramming head



Wooden stave

Damp sheepskin sponge for swabbing the barrel

▲ SPONGE

Date c.1800

Origin UK

Material Ash, copper nails, sheepskin

A damp sheepskin sponge was pushed down the barrel after every shot had been fired to extinguish residual burning embers. Copper nails attached the sponge to the head of a wooden stave.



Barrel

Muzzle

► CAST-IRON 3-POUNDER

Date Late 17th century

Origin England

Length 2m (6½ft)

Calibre 3in

Shot 1.36kg (3lb)

Cast-iron guns were much cheaper to make than bronze guns and gradually replaced them during the 17th and 18th centuries. They were cast solid and bored out. The rear-chock carriage lessened recoil when the gun was fired.



Button to help in lifting and moving gun

Naval rear-chock carriage

► MUZZLE-LOADING 12-POUNDER

Date 1805

Origin UK

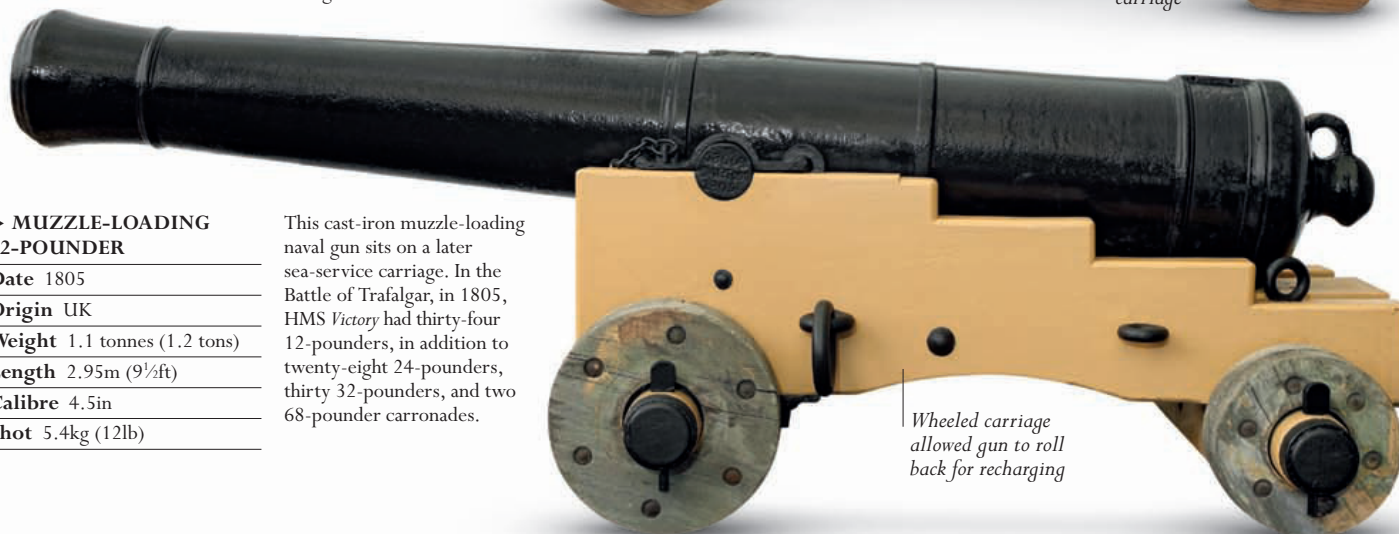
Weight 1.1 tonnes (1.2 tons)

Length 2.95m (9½ft)

Calibre 4.5in

Shot 5.4kg (12lb)

This cast-iron muzzle-loading naval gun sits on a later sea-service carriage. In the Battle of Trafalgar, in 1805, HMS *Victory* had thirty-four 12-pounders, in addition to twenty-eight 24-pounders, thirty 32-pounders, and two 68-pounder carronades.



Wheeled carriage allowed gun to roll back for recharging